Our focus on tonight's Treasures is to **"Help Others Benefit From Jehovah's Mercy."**

Interestingly, Jeremiah chapter 50 gives us two contrasting accounts involving Babylon and repentant Israelites. These accounts teach us something beautiful about Jehovah's mercy and what we ought to do as Christians.

We need to understand something: We all make mistakes, one way or the other. However, when we make a serious mistake or sin against Jehovah, what matters is our attitude afterward.

Are we remorseful? Do we recognize the wrong we have done, feel genuinely sorry, and make the necessary changes?

Or do we refuse correction and become even more arrogant?

In the case of Babylon. Let's first consider Babylon. Notice the reason Jehovah gave for condemning Babylon at: **Jeremiah 50:14 "Come against Babylon in battle formation on every side, All you who are bending the bow. Shoot at her, spare no arrow,** *[notice]* **For it is against Jehovah that she has sinned."**

Please do we see the reason in final part of this verse? *"**For it is against Jehovah that she has sinned**."* You see, if this expression could be rendered this way, directly attributing Babylon sins against Jehovah, it wasn't like our day-to-day flaws with our brothers and sisters. Say maybe we jokingly laughed about how old a brother's shoe looks like, and he gets to know of it and gets offended. We could humbly apologize there and there, and that would be the right thing to do, it would be between us; it wouldn't have to cross over to heavens and hurt Jehovah's feelings. But for Babylon's conduct, it amounted to sinning greatly against Jehovah himself, that the verse could say this, you can imagine the expression of these words.

Okay, they have sinned, what will be their attitude? Please, notice that also in latter part of verse 29, **29Summon archers against Babylon, All who are bending the bow. Camp all around her; let no one escape. Repay her according to her activity. Do to her just as she has done. For she has acted arrogantly against Jehovah, Against the Holy One of Israel.**

This is the very wrong attitude for Babylon's great sin, to be arrogant. In the same verse, the last two sentences from this, it said, "**Repay her according to her activity."** So, it was like a debt, Jehovah is fair, Jehovah is a God of just. So, it continues in the verse, **"Do to her just as she has done."** And what was done to her? We saw it in verse 14, the preceding part, verse 29 also, Jehovah condemned them. In ancient wars, the archers, they were skilled warriors, very were serious killers. They spare no arrow. And so, that was complete death for Babylon.

Again, at verse 31, there, Jehovah speaks concerning their attitude using another strong expression. **31"Look! I am against you, O defiant one," declares the Sovereign Lord, Jehovah of armies, "For your day must come, the time that I will call you to account."**

The reference bible, on Jeremiah 50: 29 and 31, uses the expression presumptuousness, for these two words, "arrogant" and "defiant" translated in our revised edition, so we could more readily understand. Yes, this is an unusual word, a very big word, indeed.

What does presumptuousness mean? Already we got these two words from our revised edition "arrogant", "defiant", another is "excessive pride", "overconfidence" the list goes on and on.

In fact, the insight explains that ancient Babylon was a prototype of presumptuousness against God. What this also means is that Babylon was a blueprint, the original version, so they made up presumptuousness.

Furthermore, Jehovah's most bitter enemy is symbolic Babylon the Great. For one thing, the scriptures liken false worship to adultery. Jehovah sees our involvement in her as being drunk with sexual immorality. Disgusting thing in Jehovah's eyes. Babylon is responsible for the blood of many innocent people. However, we should be glad Jehovah will everlastingly destroy Babylon the Great. For that is how the verse ended it, at Jeremiah 50:31. **Her day must come, the time that Jehovah will call her to account.**

Brothers and sisters, Jehovah has promised to bring an end to all Babylonish presumptuousness: "her pride, her haughtiness, **Isaiah 13:11** said.

But now, here is where we see the beautiful contrast at **Jeremiah 50:20**, notice what it said at **Jeremiah 50:20 "In those days and at that time," declares Jehovah, "Israel's guilt will be searched for, But there will be none, And the sins of Judah will not be found, For I will forgive those whom I let remain."** How comforting this is. The verse started saying, "in those days and at that time, so meaning at a time there were sins, Israel were guilty, **but now, in those days, their sins will be searched for, but there will be none**. Judah's sin will not be found, how? We saw it in the ending part. **For I will forgive those whom I let remain.** Jehovah is a merciful God, He's compassionate at heart. Jehovah completely forgave repentant Israelites.

And so, shouldn't we also be to move to tell people about this? That is what we ought to do as true Christians. Please notice that also at **Jeremiah 50:2** see that for ourselves **"2"Declare it among the nations and proclaim it. Raise a signal and proclaim it. Do not hide anything! Say, 'Babylon has been captured. Bel has been put to shame. Mer'o·dach has become terrified. Her images have been put to shame. Her disgusting idols have become terrified."** Where is your signal? Being here is already a signal that we want to declare Jehovah's mercy to people. We're glad we've got out of her. That is why we are here in pure worship to Jehovah. Because at verse 8, **Jeremiah 50:8** it stated to **"8"Flee out of the midst of Babylon.**

Today, billions of humans are involved in various forms of false religion. False religion has a long history of supporting the political rulers of this world. They are involved in many wars, acts of pedophilia and other forms of sexual immorality committed by clergymen and tolerated by the church authorities.

But as for we true Christians, knowing this. We have an obligation to warn members of Babylon the Great. One way is by distributing Bible studies, we have our bibles and related literature published by "the faithful and discreet slave," whom Jesus appointed to provide spiritual "food at the proper time." We want to raise this signal and declare and proclaim it to the nations, as verse 8 says to "tell people to flee out of the midst of Babylon.

And that is exactly what we see in this picture illustration. This young beautiful sister proclaiming and declaring to this aged sister, who may be on the verge of fleeing out of Babylon, yes, it tells what she was learning has touched her heart, and that will do away with all those statues and cross behind her.

Brothers and sisters, we have seen it. Babylon sinned greatly and had an arrogant attitude against Jehovah so they faced their judgment. But Jehovah willingly and completely forgave his repentant Israelites.

May we all strive to share the Goodnews as we show appreciation for Jehovah's mercy by helping as many people as possible come to know Jehovah.